

DOCUMENT PREPARATION INSTRUCTIONS:

AI tool usage will be something we discuss throughout the semester – those uses that improve and those that impair learning. In an effort to gain insights about AI tool use in paper-writing and to discourage generated language copying, you will need to use this Google Doc to write and edit your collaborative reflection assignment. Complete the heading section below and use that in place of the traditional title page. Your collaborative essay should be written on the pages that follow.

Details: You'll need to complete this assignment using this document alone. You will need to do all writing, editing, and revising *in this document* to enable the [creation of an Origin Writing Report](#). This report will collect data about each student's work (for example, it tracks the time you spend on writing/editing, and whether any chunks of text are pasted into the document). It also performs an AI Scan and suggests whether AI was likely used to write portions of this assignment.

You should not write any portions of this assignment elsewhere and then copy it into the document – all text should originate in this document. You may take notes by hand and then type it in later, of course. You should also not copy and paste AI-generated text into this document (as that would violate MU's policy).

HEADING – keep this heading in your document – this is your title page

Important: click on “Share” in the upper right-hand corner and under General Access, click on “Anyone with the Link” and the “Editor” function to the right. Both must be selected for your work to be counted as submitted correctly. Please embed hyperlinks so we can easily click on these Google Docs.

Your Name: Ariuntsetseg Mandakh

Link to **your** copy of this Google Doc: [Link](#)

Your collaborator's Name (the person who is responding to you): Jiho Woo

Link to your **partner's** copy of this Google Doc: [Link](#)

For groups of 3, the name of the person to whom you are responding:

Link to this **partner's** copy of this Google Doc:

Total word length of Parts 1, 2, 3 (excluding footnotes, appendix):

Include a complete note describing your use of any AI Tools (none are required). See the [following document](#) for detailed information about this requirement.

(Begin your assignment response on the next page, double-spacing your responses.)

Assignment Explanation

For your second assignment, you'll **collaborate with a peer** from class in a letter exchange assignment. You'll each write a philosophical letter addressed to a Unit 3 author in our class. ["Dear Prof. Young," for example] Your peer will reply to your letter from that author's perspective. These letters will be submitted at three points during Unit 3 and will be discussed in class. Your final submission will be a compilation of these three letters.

You'll each be responsible for writing an initial letter in which you pose a possible problem with one argument **advanced by an author in Unit 3**. You may choose an author whose work we have not yet read, but that will require that you read ahead of schedule. You'll choose which author you'd like to object to and will address the letter to them. Then, you'll exchange letters with a partner from class. You'll each be responsible for writing a response to your partner's argument from the author's perspective, and for evaluating a student's application of one LO or HC based on their draft. After you receive your partner's reply to your objection, you'll write a final letter in which you offer a response to their objection. Your final submission of the letter portfolio will consist of these three sections, and your LO/HC footnotes/appendix.

Important Note: Since this involves working with a partner, you must meet the requirements and deadlines described below. You also won't be able to apply personal extensions to this assignment, as it is a group assignment. *You won't be able to edit your letters in Part 1 or 2 after each of the intermediate deadlines has passed, so make sure that you think of these as deadlines for **finished** work instead of rough drafts.*

Write your responses to each part in the spaces below.

PART 1: Write a letter addressed to an author in Unit 3 (500-600 words) in which you first closely analyze one of the Unit 3 authors' arguments and then pose a specific objection to this argument. This letter must be written in paragraphs, not in outline or bullet-point style. Choose a reading assigned in Unit 3. Given the length constraints, it's important to prioritize a small and focused part of their overall argument, which you can explain in detail and in terms of the author's reasoning in the space provided. It is useful to connect the focus of your analysis of their argument to the overarching context of their article/essay as a whole, but you should minimize broad strokes, superficial summaries, and generalizations.

You will be paired with a student during class, with whom you will work on this project.

Include two LO footnotes: an LO footnote for #challenges and one of the interpretive LOs listed above. *This is not a draft of a letter. You should submit the version of Part 1 that you will be scored on when you compile each section. While you can make small editing changes to refine grammar and spelling, you won't be able to revise the substance of your argument.*

Dear Professor Young,

I read your essay “Responsibility and Global Justice” and found your Social Connection Model (SCM) a compelling alternative to the liability model (LM). Your critique of LM, particularly its tendency to isolate individual perpetrators and frame injustice as the result of a few “bad actors,” is persuasive. By contrast, SCM’s emphasis on the structural and collective production of injustice offers a more adequate account of how global inequalities persist. I’m writing to raise a concern about the conditions under which the kind of political responsibility you describe can be meaningfully exercised.

As I understand it, SCM holds individuals responsible for participating in and often benefiting from structural processes that produce injustice, even if they do not directly intend or fully understand those outcomes. Yet the ability to recognize and act on this responsibility depends on conditions of awareness that are themselves shaped by the economic and media structures that also produce these injustices. In many contemporary societies, individuals' awareness of these structural connections is itself shaped and often limited by the very systems in which they participate. In highly mediated environments, particularly those structured by algorithmic social media, perceptions of what is normal, acceptable, or even visible are continuously shaped through repetition and curation. These environments actively structure attention and normalize certain patterns of consumption and social life. An empirical study of algorithmic curation across platforms such as Facebook, TikTok, and YouTube found that algorithms reconfigure what counts as newsworthy by prioritizing engagement and shareability over editorial significance. This reconfiguration operates at the level of institutional norms rather than individual preferences (Hastuti et al., 2025). As a result,

individuals may find it difficult to recognize their own position within unjust structures, not due to negligence, but because their epistemic environment is already filtered in ways that obscure those connections.

A concrete example can be seen in fast fashion consumption on platforms such as TikTok and Instagram. Users are repeatedly exposed to curated content that presents rapid clothing turnover as ordinary and desirable. The algorithm promotes affordability, trends, and personal expression while rarely making visible the labor conditions behind production. A consumer engaging with this content may unknowingly participate in exploitative global supply chains while experiencing their behavior as entirely normal. This suggests that the same structures that generate injustice can also shape how that injustice is perceived, limiting an individual's capacity to recognize their own involvement.

This creates an asymmetric awareness between agents. Someone with the time, resource, and critical distance to understand structural injustice stands in a very different position from someone whose perception of social reality has been largely shaped by such mediated environments. While your parameters of power, privilege, interest, and collective ability do capture why those in more powerful positions, including those who design and regulate media systems, bear greater responsibility, they remain primarily oriented toward material and social positioning. These parameters do not fully account for how the same structures can limit the awareness of less powerful agents, thereby constraining their ability to recognize and act on their own responsibility.¹

¹ **#ah111-powercritique** - I engaged with power by showing how it operates through algorithmic media to shape norms, attention, and perceptions of what is "normal." This extends structural oppression beyond economic systems into epistemic environments. My example demonstrates how power can obscure injustice by normalizing participation in it.

My concern is not that individuals shouldn't be responsible for something they are unaware but unawareness limits the capacity to recognize and respond to it. If agents cannot recognize their connection to structural injustice, then the practical exercise of political responsibility becomes significantly constrained. I raise this not as a rejection of your framework, but as a possible extension of it. A fuller account of political responsibility is distributed, but also the conditions under which agents can recognize and act upon it.²

Word Count: 587 words

AI Statement: In this assignment, I worked closely with the reading, taking detailed notes, writing on paper, editing, and then pasting the results into the document. I used Grammarly to correct my grammatical mistakes. Other than that, I didn't use generative AI to generate texts and paste them directly into the paper.

² **#ah-pel-challenges** - I challenges Iris Marion Young's Social Connection Model by questioning whether individuals can meaningfully act on responsibility given unequal awareness shaped by structural conditions. Instead of rejecting her view, I refined it by shifting the focus from responsibility itself to the capacity to exercise it. This strengthens my position by showing that structural injustice also affects perception, not just material conditions.

PART 2: (a) Write an evaluation of one of the LOs applied by the student in their draft (roughly 150 words), and then (b) write a 250-300 word response letter *from the perspective of the author* they are addressing. You should carefully identify the premise, claim, or inference in their argument that you are targeting with their objection, and provide a justification for your response. It's also often quite helpful to give an example to support your reasoning. *This is also not a draft. Your submission will be included with the final assignment submission.*

Include a footnote for #challenges (applied to your own writing) in your Part 2 letter, with a few sentences explaining how you applied it particularly well.

(a) Evaluation By Jiho Woo

Ariuka effectively demonstrates how power operates through algorithmic media not by directly coercing individuals, but by shaping what feels "normal" and thereby obscuring participation in injustice. The fast fashion example is particularly well-chosen, as it concretely illustrates how platforms like TikTok normalize exploitative consumption patterns without users ever perceiving themselves as complicit. The inclusion of Hastuti et al. (2025) strengthens the argument by grounding it empirically, showing that algorithmic curation reshapes norms at an institutional level rather than merely reflecting individual preferences. This meaningfully extends the concept of 'structural oppression' into the epistemic domain as she mentioned in the footnote. One area for development would be explicitly situating this analysis within existing power theories, such as Foucault's 'disciplinary power' or Gramsci's 'hegemony to clarify what is distinctively new about algorithmic mediation as a mechanism of power', and how it differs from or builds upon these established frameworks.

(b) Response from Iris Marion Young

Dear Ariuka,

Thank you for your thoughtful engagement with my Social Connection Model. You raise an important concern: that the very structures producing injustice also constrain individuals' awareness of their participation in it, thereby limiting their capacity to exercise political responsibility. I appreciate that you frame this as an extension rather than a rejection, and I want to respond in that spirit.

However, I believe your argument rests on a premise that overstates the epistemic constraints facing agents. You suggest that individuals embedded in algorithmically mediated environments may be unable to recognize their structural connections to injustice because their perception is filtered in ways that obscure those connections. While I acknowledge that awareness is unevenly distributed, your framing risks treating epistemic limitation as epistemic incapacity. This distinction matters considerably. If we accept that mediated environments make agents genuinely unable to recognize injustice, we risk excusing inaction on the grounds of ignorance - precisely the kind of societal flaw the Social Connection Model is designed to resist.³

Consider your own fast fashion example. Even within algorithmically curated platforms, users regularly encounter critical content such as documentaries about labor exploitation, activist campaigns, news coverage of factory collapses. The information is not entirely absent; rather, it competes with other content for attention. The challenge, then, is not that awareness is

³ **#challenges:** directly identifying the specific premise it targets -that epistemic limitation amounts to epistemic incapacity - and explaining why this distinction is significant for the overall argument. Rather than dismissing the Ariuka's concern, it anticipates the risk that accepting the premise too readily could undermine the Social Connection Model's core purpose of resisting deflections of responsibility. By offering the fast fashion counterexample and reframing the challenge as a supplement rather than a limitation, the response demonstrates how engaging with an objection can ultimately strengthen one's own theoretical position.

AH111 Assignment 3: Collaborative Letter Portfolio

structurally impossible but that it requires effort within an environment that discourages it. This is precisely why my parameter of privilege is relevant: those with greater access to critical resources bear greater responsibility, but this does not absolve others entirely.

What your argument helpfully highlights is that political responsibility may need to include a responsibility to seek awareness of resisting the epistemic complacency that mediated environments encourage. I would welcome this as a complement to the model's existing framework.

Sincerely,

Iris Marion Young

PART 3: Write a 400-600 word response letter to your partner's reply, and then compile the full project to be submitted as a single PDF. Your response should begin by characterizing what you take to be your partner's major objection to your initial letter. Then, you should explain your response, evaluating the strength of the objection they posed and concluding with a clear defense of your position on the author's argument (focusing on the elements you highlighted in Part 1). Your response should avoid merely restating the initial argument you developed. *This section is the only submission that should be treated as a draft of the pre-class work submission.*

Include footnotes for 2 #ah-pel LOs of your choice (other than #challenges). (#distinctionsdefinitions, #assumptions, #implications are good examples).

Appendix: Add your Part 2 letter to your partner below, along with your Part 2 #challenges footnote. Also, include your evaluation of how well your partner applied an LO in this section.

(a) LO Evaluation

The application of #ah-pel-challenges is clearly demonstrated through Jiho's analysis of the historical entitlement principle and its limitations in practice. Jiho shows a strong understanding by explaining that the principle requires extensive historical backtracking to identify when injustice occurred and how corrective justice should be applied. He then challenges this requirement by arguing that such backtracking is often impossible in practice. By drawing on examples such as colonialism and slavery, Jiho highlights the problem of incomplete or missing historical records, which makes it difficult to determine what actually happened and what a just distribution would have been. He further strengthens the challenge by emphasizing that disagreements will inevitably arise over how to interpret past injustices and how to rectify them. Without a clear method or shared standard, these disputes become ongoing and unresolved.

One area for improvement is that the challenge remains abstract. Incorporating a real-world example could strengthen the objection by making its significance more concrete.

Word Count: 157 words

(b) Letter

Dear Jiho,

Thank you for your careful engagement with my entitlement theory. You raise a serious challenge, particularly the difficulty of applying the principle of rectification. I will respond in two ways: first, that historical backtracking, while difficult, remains necessary for rectification; and second, that these practical limitations do not undermine the theory.

Firstly, your conclusion that this practical difficulty threatens the coherence of the theory itself requires closer examination. The entitlement theory doesn't claim that existing distributions are just. Instead, it identifies the conditions under which holdings would be just, and where those conditions were violated, rectification is required. The principle functions as a moral standard, not as a guarantee of full historical recovery. I would argue that a theory that acknowledges its own historical limitations is more rigorous than one that avoids confronting the past altogether. Take a Rawlsian approach, for example. Principles derived behind a veil of ignorance do not make historical injustices disappear; they simply set them aside. My framework at least requires that we confront injustice directly, even when the historical records are incomplete.

Secondly, your argument assumes that if rectification cannot be fully realized, the theory collapses. However, many principles of justice guide our moral judgments even when full compliance is unattainable. For example, we recognize that fairness in legal systems is an ideal, even though no system can eliminate all error or bias. The impossibility of complete reconstruction doesn't remove the obligation to respond to injustice wherever it can be identified. Imperfect rectification remains rectification. It reflects the theory applied under real-world constraints rather than a departure from it. Reparative settlements, targeted redress, and negotiated agreements are not substitutes for principle but practical approximations that I can endorse. The difficulty of a principle doesn't dissolve the obligation it tracks.⁴

Sincerely,

Robert Nozick

⁴ **#ah-pel-challenges:** This response addresses Jiho's objection by focusing on his main claim that the difficulty of rectification threatens the coherence of entitlement theory. It challenges Part 1 response by arguing that the theory is meant to set conditions for justice, not to guarantee that those conditions can always be fully met. By showing that the impossibility of complete historical reconstruction doesn't remove the obligation to pursue rectification, the response explains why the challenge doesn't undermine the theory and defends its core position.

Word Count: 299 words

AI Statement: For this part of the assignment, I didn't engage with AI to respond to Part 1. I had a study session with my friends who previously took AH111 and consulted my response to Part 1. I used Grammarly to correct my grammatical errors.

Bibliography:

Hastuti H, Maulana HF, Lawelai H and Suherman A (2025) *Algorithmic influence and media legitimacy: a systematic review of social media's impact on news production*. Front. Commun. 10:1667471. doi: 10.3389/fcomm.2025.1667471

Full Assignment Compilation: Your final submission should have your first letter, your partner's reply to you, your 3rd letter responding to them, and an appendix with your part 2 letter to your partner (for grading purposes). Go back and delete the instructions for Parts 1, 2, and 3 above and delete the spacing between those sections. Look closely at Part 3 and reflect on feedback you received from peers about that section. You are welcome to edit and revise Part 3 before submitting your final collection of essays. *You should not edit the Part 2 letter submitted by your partner, or the substance of the letter you wrote in Part 1.*

Double check that you have complete LOs and HCs in footnotes attached to the appropriate sections of this assignment: 5 LOs and 1 HC

Part 1: 2 LOs in total

- 1 LO from the first Course Objective, which you apply when offering an explanation of an author's argument before developing your own argument (likely #powercritique, #relationalethics, or #identitydifference) [LINK to an explanation of these LOs](#).
- 1 LO #challenges, which you apply in connection with your defense of a position by responding to an objection. [LINK to an explanation of #challenges](#).

Part 2: 1 LO (your Part 2 submission appears in your partner's letter portfolio, and in your appendix)

- 1 LO #challenges, which you apply in connection with your defense of a position by responding to an objection. [LINK to an explanation of #challenges](#).

Part 3: 2 LOs and 1 HC in total

- 2 course LOs of your choice (other than #challenges). (#distinctionsdefinitions, #assumptions, #implications are good examples)
- 1 #responsibility, with an explanation of whether you met deadlines for each stage of work, coordinated and shared feedback with your partner. [LINK to #responsibility HC Handbook entry](#).